

Nicholas Economou

+1 404-936-4863 | neconomou3@gatech.edu | [linkedin.com/in/nikoeco/](https://www.linkedin.com/in/nikoeco/)

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Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I'm excited to be considered for the position of Instructional Designer given my interdisciplinary foundation of Cognitive Science, Computer Science, and Industrial Design from Georgia Tech. Rather than just using new technologies to simply automate user output, I focused on learning environments that scaffolded critical thinking and reinforced human agency.

My pedagogical approach was shaped by my five consecutive semesters as a Graduate Teaching Assistant at Georgia Tech for the "Introduction To Cognitive Science" course. This course spanned Computer Science, Psychology, and Neuroscience cohorts. Observed student learning across different semesters that revealed a crucial dilemma: Unregulated AI adoption that led students to outsource their critical thinking skills while on the other hand, outright bans proved to be unsustainable. I conclude that educational AI must be intentionally scaffold, in order to preserve cognitive insight and productive behaviors.

I ended up dedicating my Masters thesis project to designing and prototyping an AI sketching assistant application for reflective learning. This proof of concept functioned as an instructional advisor and provided visual prompts based on users' mental models to guide users to evaluate and iterate on their own hand drawn work and learn reflectively. On completing my masters, I followed with a Google AI professional certification that equipped me with industry standard usage of AI workflows and human in the loop system design.

I welcome the opportunity to discuss my experience and to learn more about the position and the ways I might contribute my skills, enthusiasm, and prototyping capabilities with emerging technologies and learning experiences.

Best Regards,

Nicholas Economou